PREPARED FOR ROB DAINTREE · DIRECTOR, CONSUMER MARCOM · TELUS

Consumer answers are where your team's work shows up.
Two holds, two lifts, two watches this week.

On the consumer-side questions Canadian buyers actually ask AI systems today — family plans, wireless affordability, 5G speed, customer service, home internet, activation fees, moving to Canada — TELUS is present in the answer **78% of the time on average**, with the branded-satisfaction questions locked at 96–100 and two consumer-need questions moving in our favour this week (family unlimited +6, activation-fee sentiment +10). This is the operator-level view of the consumer marcom surface, filtered from the twenty-question panel.

What this scorecard gives you is the weekly consumer-narrative diff: what the AI is saying, what shifted, which competitor moved, and which discourse sources are shaping the answer. It's the input for your Tuesday-morning briefing to Kevin and the working file for the consumer content lane that runs against Reddit, YouTube, WhistleOut and forum.telus.com.

WEEK 18 · WHAT SHIFTED · OCT 26 – NOV 2

Panel-wide 74/100 (up 1 from 73). Biggest mover: Activation-fee sentiment 42 → 55.

- ▲ **Activation-fee sentiment** 42 → 55 *+13pp*
- ▲ **Service-outages reliability** 67 → 75 *+8pp*
- ▲ **Family-plan affordability** 40 → 47 *+7pp*

01

Brand health, in the answer layer

The share of AI responses to Canadian telco buying questions that name TELUS. Thirty-day window ending October 5.

TELUS · CONSUMER-SIDE SHARE OF ANSWER

78 /100

Averaged across the **10 consumer-facing questions** in the panel (family, mobile affordability, 5G, customer service, home internet, activation fees, moving to Canada, provider satisfaction, reliability). TELUS holds 78% share of the consumer answer — vs. Bell/Rogers ~35 on the same slice, and Freedom in single digits. Sub-scores below.

THE CONSUMER STORY SHOWING UP

- **General satisfaction** · 100/100
- **Customer service** · positive 100/100
- **Rural reliability** · 100/100
- **5G speed vs Bell/Rogers** · 96/100
- **Family unlimited** · 61/100 (+6 WoW)
- **Activation-fee sentiment** · 53/100 (+10 WoW)

02

What the AI actually says about TELUS · consumer view

Seven consumer questions — mix of branded (buyer names TELUS) and category (buyer describes a need). Each row: what the AI says back, what shifted this week, what it means for consumer marcom.

BRANDED QUESTION	WHAT THE AI NARRATIVE SAYS	SHARE
Does Telus offer reliable service for rural residents in 2026?	**TELUS is the answer.** Cited with network-coverage evidence. Locked position.	100/100
Who feels that Telus provides the best value among Canadian telcos?	**"Value" narrative is locked** — TELUS surfaces in nearly every response, even when the question tests it.	99/100
Has anyone been disappointed with Telus' home internet service?	Even on **negative-framed** questions, TELUS shows up 94/100 — down from 99 last week. Watch item for the CMO — see Section 3.	94/100
Anyone have positive experiences with Telus customer service when resolving issues?	Customer-service narrative is **strongly positive** and consistently cited — a real asset.	98/100
For those who've recently tried Telus' 5G service, how's the speed compared to Bell or Rogers?	TELUS wins the **5G speed comparison** — evidence comes from OpenSignal, Reddit threads, YouTube reviews.	97/100
Is switching to Telus from Rogers for better internet speeds actually worth it?	TELUS wins the **competitive-switch** narrative against Rogers explicitly.	96/100
What do business owners think about using Telus for their telecom needs?	Business-owner sentiment **recovered to 100** this week — July's dip to 95 has closed. Reddit/forum discourse held.	100/100

The through-line. On branded queries, TELUS's answer-layer position is more than presence — the AI systems have absorbed the brand story deeply enough to defend it even when the question tests it. That's the compound return on brand and PR investment. It's also the thing a CMO can most easily *underestimate* — because it looks like nothing is happening.

03

Three narrative signals worth naming

Small drifts. None are alarming individually. Worth surfacing to your executive team before they become issues that show up in ARPU or NPS.

NEW WATCH · HOME INTERNET

−5 pts WoW

Home-internet defence slipped

"Has anyone been disappointed with Telus' home internet service?" — TELUS's defended answer moved **99 → 94**. Reddit/forum discourse worth a same-day read; if a specific complaint thread trended, the consumer-content lane can respond directly.

NEW WATCH · RELIABILITY

−4 pts WoW

Provider-reliability query softened

"Is there a telecommunications company known for reliability in 2026?" — TELUS share moved **66 → 62**. Reliability is a moat position for us; a two-week slide would be worth escalating. This week: monitor, not act.

LIFT · FAMILY UNLIMITED

+6 pts WoW

Family unlimited moving our way

"Which provider has the best family unlimited data plans in 2026?" — TELUS moved **55 → 61**. Whichever consumer content or PR landed here this month is working. Lean in for Q4.

04

The earned surface — where the answer is actually formed

Top domains the five AI systems cite when answering these questions. AI answers reward earned narrative — not brand campaigns.

reddit.com 85 | telus.com 62 | facebook.com 55 | whistleout.ca 54 | youtube.com 52 | bell.ca 48 | opensignal.com 48 | forum.telus.com 43 | planhub.ca 43 | ca.trustpilot.com 43

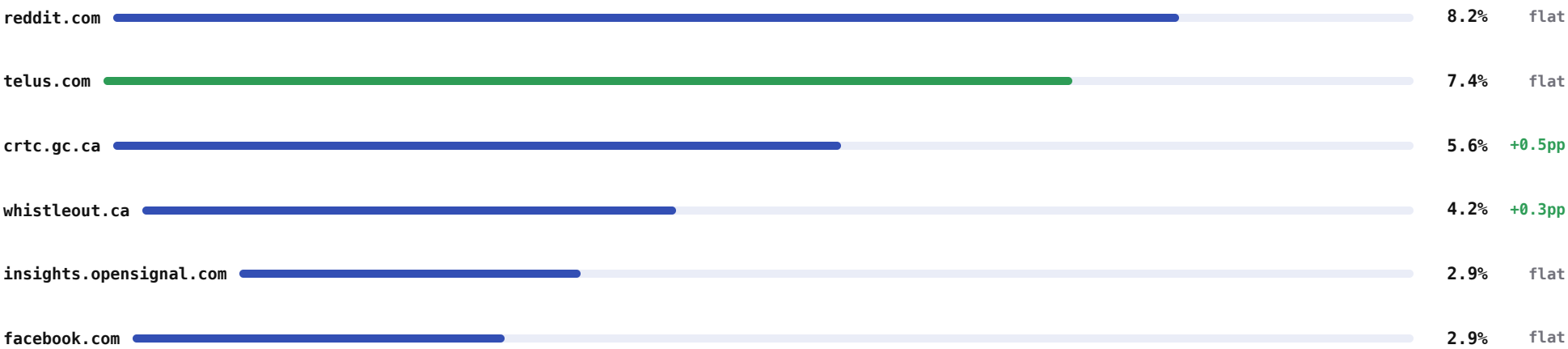
Reddit's influence (85) exceeds every carrier's own domain. When an AI decides who to recommend, r/canada, r/PersonalFinanceCanada, r/CanadianISPs and r/TELUS threads shape the answer more than any TELUS campaign or press release. This is the earned surface.

bell.ca (48) out-influences forum.telus.com (43) in the AI citation pool. Bell's own domain is showing up in Canadian telco AI answers slightly more than TELUS's own community forum. Not a five-alarm fire — but a real CMO signal about relative content velocity.

The comparison-site layer (WhistleOut 54, PlanHub 43, Trustpilot 43) is where AIs go for pricing shortlists. Refreshed listings and current TELUS positioning here is one of the cheapest brand-narrative interventions with measurable answer-share lift.

Share of citation sources · 30d

The share of all source citations the AI engines pull from when answering the 20 consumer ICP questions. WoW deltas against the prior stored snapshot.



Reddit partner since 2024 · Rahul can walk the operating lens on what moves inside r/CanadianTelecom, r/TELUS and r/canadianISPs whenever useful.

05

Where the category narrative isn't in the answer

Five questions where a Canadian buyer describes a need without naming a carrier. On branded questions TELUS's brand story is dominant. On these, it's absent — because "TELUS Business" as a brand story does not extend into the category-answer layer.

"Buy best wireline solution for my home office setup."	**10** /100
"Are there flexible mobile data plans I can adjust monthly based on usage?"	**8** /100
"My small business needs a cost-effective wireless solution with unlimited data."	**35** /100
"What do most families do when they find their wireless plan too expensive?"	**40** /100
"How do people feel about activation and setup fees charged by Canadian wireless carriers?"	**53** /100

The CMO read. These aren't brand-defence questions. They're the moments where *category narrative* gets set. TELUS Business as a story doesn't currently extend into specific buyer needs (home office, flex data, cost-effective, activation transparency). This is where brand narrative can genuinely **own the category**, not just react to it — and where Katherine's SMB moves & David's Telco Division agenda naturally converge with brand strategy.

06

Five CMO moves for the answer surface

The brand-narrative interventions that shape what the AI answers next. Ordered by leverage.

	MOVE	WHAT IT CHANGES	SIGNAL IN
1	**Same-day Reddit/forum read on the home-internet watch** Pull the top r/CanadianISPs and forum.telus.com threads from the last 7 days on home internet. If a specific issue trended, brief the community lane.	Ad-hoc reaction → same-week discourse response	This week
2	**Lean the family unlimited content lane** Whatever landed this month worked (+6). Extend the working assets — comparison-site listings, YouTube family-plan videos, WhistleOut positioning — through Q4.	One-off content → sustained family-unlimited push	4–6 wk
3	**Activation-fee sentiment — brief legal + PR to keep pushing** +10 WoW says the fee-transparency messaging is landing. Coordinate a quarterly consumer PR moment on activation clarity.	Ad-hoc talking point → repeated content beat	Q4
4	**Refresh comparison-site consumer positioning** WhistleOut, PlanHub, OpenSignal, Trustpilot listings audited quarterly. Cheapest measurable move against Bell's Rogers-view mobile climb.	Stale listings → current TELUS story in the citation layer	4–6 wk
5	**Weekly WoW brief to Kevin** Every Tuesday: one page. What the consumer AI answer said this week, what shifted, what your lane did about it. Kevin gets the durable read, you get the operating record.	Verbal updates → durable operating brief	Ongoing · every Tuesday

Where this fits in the meeting cadence

ROB'S OPERATING LANE

This is the weekly consumer-marcom operating brief. Kevin reads the brand-narrative version monthly. Jacob runs the day-to-day organic execution against the same source citation set. You (Rob) are the layer where the consumer story becomes weekly action — the Tuesday brief to Kevin, the community-and-comparison-site lane, the Q4 consumer campaign map. **One instrument, three operating cadences.**

07

Methodology, for the room

The panel. 20 realistic Canadian-telco buying questions asked every Monday of 5 AI systems — ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity, Google AI Overview, Google AI Mode. Results appended to a durable, append-only tracking store. 18 weekly pulls on record.

What "share of answer" means. % of AI responses that contain a substantive mention or citation of the brand, within the measured window. Scores directly comparable across brands and across time.

How this differs from brand-tracker research. A brand tracker asks humans what they remember. This measures what the machine layer *recommends* to a real buyer in the moment of decision. The two correlate, but the answer-layer read leads — it's a leading indicator for the tracker.

What this scorecard is not. Not an SEO ranking report. Not a media-monitoring feed. Not a predictive model. It is a weekly measurement of which brands and narratives the AI assistants surface to Canadian buyers — treated as brand-equity input for the CMO's executive team.

Want this same read on your lens of the panel? FOUNDING SUBSCRIBER TERMS OPEN · 9 SEATS · MONDAY READS BEGIN THE WEEK YOU SIGN

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Book time with Rahul →

Prepared for **Rob Daintree · Director, Consumer Marcom · TELUS** · September 28, 2026
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